Gỏi cuốn

Fresh rice paper rolls with prawns, noodles and herbs, and a hoisin peanut dip

Makes 8 rolls, for 2–4 · **Prep** 25 min · **Cook** 5 min

> *Draft quantities for David to check. The vault note names the ingredients and steps but no amounts, so the quantities and timings are worked out and haven't been tested.*

Fresh spring rolls that can be rolled ahead or at the table. Soften the rice paper only briefly: it keeps softening on the board, and soaked too long it tears.

INGREDIENTS

For the rolls

- 50 g rice vermicelli
- 8 sheets rice paper, about 22 cm (8½ in) across
- 16 cooked prawns, halved lengthways, or 200 g cooked chicken in strips
- ½ cucumber, cut into thin sticks
- 1 small bunch mint, leaves picked
- 1 small bunch coriander, leaves picked

For the dip

- 4 tbsp hoisin sauce
- 1 tbsp peanut butter
- 2–3 tbsp warm water

METHOD

1. **Cook the noodles.** Boil the vermicelli for 3–5 minutes, then drain, rinse under cold water and drain well.
2. **Make the dip.** Stir the hoisin and peanut butter together, then add warm water a spoonful at a time until it pours.
3. **Soften the rice paper.** Dip one sheet in a wide bowl of warm water for about 5 seconds and lay it flat on a damp board.
4. **Fill.** Across the lower third, lay a small handful of noodles, some herbs, cucumber and four prawn halves (cut side up, so they show through).
5. **Roll.** Fold the bottom edge over the filling, fold in the sides, and roll up tightly. Repeat with the rest.
6. **Serve.** Serve straight away with the dip.

NOTES

- To roll at the table, set out the fillings and a bowl of warm water and let everyone make their own.
- Rolls kept under a damp tea towel stay soft for an hour or two; in the fridge the rice paper hardens.